We encourage our team to travel. #businessgrowth #motivation #sucessjourney #mindset

Channel: Greg Lav · Published: Oct 12, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/shorts/OU1yntAszwQ Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Greg Lav argues that keeping a team geographically confined causes them to unconsciously build products for a local niche, undermining the goal of serving a national or global audience.

📑 Contents

- 🌍 Why Travel Is Strongly Encouraged
- 📍 The Venice Beach / Los Angeles Example
- 🎯 The Core Risk: Unintentional Audience Narrowing

🌍 Why Travel Is Strongly Encouraged 0:00

- The company actively pushes its team members to travel
  - Staying within a single geographic bubble is framed as one of the worst things that can happen to a team
  - Exposure to different places, cultures, and communities broadens the mental model of who the customer actually is

📍 The Venice Beach / Los Angeles Example 0:00

- When the entire team was based in Venice Beach, California, a subtle but damaging pattern emerged
  - The team began unconsciously creating products tailored to the Venice Beach and broader Los Angeles community
  - This was not a deliberate strategic choice — it happened organically because of the team's shared local environment and daily experiences
  - The realization came as a wake-up call: "Hey, we are making products for all of America — and now for the whole world — yet we are effectively narrowing the target audience of these products because we only think in terms of Los Angeles."

🎯 The Core Risk: Unintentional Audience Narrowing 0:21

- The danger is not malicious or obvious — it is subtle and accumulates over time
  - A team embedded in one zip code or city will naturally reflect that city's tastes, problems, aesthetics, and assumptions in its work

    - For a brand with national or global ambitions, this misalignment between intended audience and actual design perspective is a strategic liability

      > The biggest insight: your team's physical environment silently shapes your product decisions — travel is a deliberate countermeasure to keep thinking broad.

- Implied takeaway: rotating team members through different cities, regions, or countries helps ensure the product vision remains inclusive and representative of a diverse customer base